Manuscript (Results section): Assignment Brief (Individual Product 2)

Foundations of Clinical Research · Level 1: From Clinical Question to Publication

Organisation: Neudata (*#ClearDataClearImpact*)

Who: every participant, on their own. There are no groups.

Required: a complete, submission-ready **Results section** for one FLUID-ICU question (Q1 to Q5), with a working title, Table 1 and one main results table or figure.

Optional: Methods, Introduction, Discussion and Abstract. Trainers give feedback on these too.

What we give you: the results. You do not analyse any data.

Shared: at the end of Session 6, when you choose your question.

Marked with: `Manuscript_Rubric.pdf` (formative). Peer review: `Peer_Review_Instructions.pdf`.

1. Purpose

In the proposal you plan a study that has not been done. Here you report one that has. You write the Results section of a FLUID-ICU paper to the standard a journal expects: every number correct, every estimate with its 95% CI, tables that stand alone and no interpretation. If you have time, you can write the other sections too.

> **Simulated data.** FLUID-ICU is a simulated training dataset. Put this sentence under your title: "This manuscript uses simulated data created for training. It reports no real patients." Never submit it to a journal.

2. Choose one question (end of Session 6)

All five questions are worked through in Sessions 5 and 6 (Q1 in full). By the end of Session 6, choose one and tell the course lead in the chat or by email. Any number of participants may choose the same question. Q1 is modelled live in Session 7, so it is the easiest start.

Q	Research question	Main analysis in the results pack
Q1	Is a positive fluid balance by day 3 associated with higher 28-day mortality?	Crude and adjusted logistic regression (OR), Kaplan-Meier curves and Cox model (HR)
Q2	Is cumulative fluid balance associated with acute kidney injury (AKI)?	Crude and adjusted logistic regression
Q3	Is cumulative fluid balance associated with fewer ventilator-free days?	Linear regression and a non-parametric comparison
Q4	Is initial lactate associated with 28-day mortality, and does the answer change with how missing lactate is handled?	Logistic regression, complete-case analysis vs multiple imputation
Q5	Among survivors, is fluid balance associated with a longer ICU stay?	Median (IQR), linear regression on the log scale or non-parametric tests

3. What you receive (by email)

File	What it is for
`Results_Pack_QN.pdf` (N = your question)	All the numbers: participant flow, Table 1, results tables, figures, plain-language notes
`Manuscript_Template_IMRaD.docx`	Write in this template. The Results section is marked as required
`SAP_FLUID-ICU.pdf` and `Data_Dictionary.pdf`	Definitions and analysis methods, for the optional Methods
`Response_to_Reviewers_Template.docx`	For your reply to your reviewer

Use only the numbers in your results pack. If something is missing, ask the instructor.

4. What you write

Required

Part	What we expect
Working title	One line naming the population, exposure, outcome and design, e.g. "Positive fluid balance by day 3 and 28-day mortality in sepsis: a multicentre cohort study"
Results text	STROBE items 13 to 17, in this order: (1) participants and flow, (2) baseline characteristics (Table 1) and missing data, (3) outcome numbers per group, (4) the main result, crude and adjusted, with 95% CI, (5) other analyses in your pack (sensitivity, imputation or subgroup). About 400 to 600 words
Table 1	Baseline characteristics by exposure group, from your results pack
Main results table or figure	e.g. crude and adjusted estimates, or the Kaplan-Meier curve (Q1)
Two statements	The simulated-data sentence (section 1) and the AI-use statement (section 6)

Submission-ready means:

- every number agrees with your results pack

- percentages have denominators and estimates have 95% CIs
- each table and figure stands alone (title, units, n, abbreviations explained)
- no interpretation ("because", "suggests", "significant trend")
- written in the template, in the past tense

Optional (encouraged)

Part	Notes
Methods	STROBE items 4 to 12. All the information is in the results pack, the SAP and the data dictionary. Shown in Session 7
Introduction	Three paragraphs: what is known, what is not known, the aim. Session 8
Discussion	Six moves: answer, compare, explain, limitations, implications, conclusion. Session 8
Abstract	Structured, 250 words or fewer. Session 8

Send optional parts in the same file as your Results. They are not marked, but you get written feedback.

5. Timeline

When	What happens
Sessions 5 and 6	The class reads the data, Table 1 and the results together
End of Session 6 (5 December)	You choose your question and receive this brief
Session 7 (12 December)	Manuscript workshop 1: the instructor writes the Q1 Results live with the class, then you start yours. **Your reviewer is announced**
Session 8 (19 December)	Manuscript workshop 2: improve your Results section, and an introduction to the optional parts
23:59, Saturday 19 December 2026	Results draft due. Email it to your reviewer and to the course lead
Saturday 2 January 2027 (2 weeks after Session 8)	Review report due. Email it to the author and to the course lead
Saturday 30 January 2027 (4 weeks after the review)	Revised Results section and response to the reviewer due

6. Rules

- **Numbers:** only from your results pack. Round without changing the meaning.
- **Language:** FLUID-ICU is observational. Write "associated with", never "caused" or "led to".
- **Missing data:** say how much was missing, as in your pack.
- **Originality:** your own words. Two participants with the same question have the same numbers but not the same text.
- **AI-use statement (required):** at the end, write either "AI use: none." or "AI use: [tool] was used to [improve the English / translate]. The author checked every sentence and takes full responsibility." AI must not produce results or write the text for you. Never paste a classmate's draft into an AI tool.

7. Submission and file names

Write in English. If English is impossible for you, Vietnamese is accepted. Send every file by email to the course lead, Vương Mỹ Lượng, at **myluong1710@gmail.com**.

File	Send to	Due
`Surname_Firstname_Results_QN.docx`, e.g. `Nguyen_An_Results_Q2.docx`	Your reviewer and the course lead	23:59, 19 December 2026
`Surname_Firstname_Review.docx` (your review of a classmate's draft)	The author and the course lead	2 January 2027
`Surname_Firstname_Results_QN_revised.docx` (tracked changes) and `Surname_Firstname_Response.docx`	The course lead	30 January 2027

8.

- You receive a review from your classmate, and written comments from the instructors on the revised Results section (or on the draft, if no revision arrives) and on any optional parts.
- **The marks are formative.**